ROALLA



EXECUTIVE AI PORTFOLIO AND COST CONTROL GUIDE

Enterprise AI Agent and Cost Governance 2027

Control agent proliferation and avoidable spend without slowing responsible innovation

Prepared for chief executives, finance, technology, risk, security, procurement and business leaders

Prepared by ROALLA Transformation and Technology Advisory

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Purpose

This guide helps management teams understand and govern the rapidly expanding portfolio of AI agents, copilots, embedded AI features, models and supporting services entering the enterprise in 2026 and 2027. It provides a defensible method to quantify avoidable spend, identify overlapping or unowned services, challenge the economics of agentic workflows, establish policy and create a practical operating cadence for investment, control and retirement.

EXECUTIVE DECISION DASHBOARD

Management View at a Glance

Most organizations do not have an AI price problem alone. They have an inventory, ownership and unit-economics problem. Management should establish one enterprise register, one cost taxonomy and one production gate, then require every agent or AI service to retain an accountable owner, bounded authority, measurable outcome, complete cost view and scheduled renewal or retirement decision.

Executive question	ROALLA view	Decision implication
Is there a reliable market average for AI overpayment?	**NO**	Published studies show widespread overspend and cloud waste, but not one comparable enterprise AI percentage.
Should management set an avoidable-spend target?	**PURSUE**	Calculate it from company evidence and use ROALLA diagnostic bands, not a claimed universal average.
Should every team select its own agent stack?	**CONDITIONAL**	Preserve bounded experimentation while using common procurement, identity, data, telemetry and production gates.
Can premium models remain the default?	**NO**	Use the least expensive model that meets measured quality, risk and latency requirements.
What should management authorize now?	**PURSUE**	A 90-day AI portfolio, economics and policy reset with visible owners and retirement decisions.

Recommended Management Posture

Calculate the Avoidable AI Spend Rate as duplicate licences, dormant commitments, low-value consumption, unnecessary premium-model use, avoidable retries and loops, redundant supporting services and attributable rework divided by total AI run-rate. ROALLA diagnostic bands are: under 10 percent Controlled; 10 to 20 percent Opportunity; 20 to 35 percent Material Leakage; above 35 percent Structural Sprawl. These are management thresholds, not claimed industry averages.

Questions to Put to the Leadership Team

1. How many AI agents and services do we operate, including pilots, embedded features and expensed tools?
2. Who owns the business outcome, technical operation, risk decision, cost centre and retirement date for each one?
3. Which services overlap, and which seats, commitments or agents are dormant?
4. What is the complete cost per successful outcome, including human review and rework?
5. Where are premium models used, and what evidence shows that a lower-cost model is insufficient?
6. Which agents can take action, access sensitive data or spend money, and where is human approval required?
7. What stops a loop, retry storm, tool failure or vendor change from creating cost or operational exposure?
8. What evidence would cause us to scale, renegotiate, replace, pause or retire this service?

EXECUTIVE DECISION MODEL

The Eight AI Portfolio Control Gates

These gates convert scattered AI experimentation into an investable enterprise portfolio. They apply to standalone subscriptions, embedded copilots, internally built agents, model APIs, autonomous workflows and the data, orchestration and monitoring services they consume.

Stage	Gate	Required conclusion	Decision evidence
01	Inventory	Every agent and AI service is visible	Enterprise register, discovery evidence, contract and technical identifiers
02	Ownership	Business and technical accountability is named	Outcome owner, product owner, cost centre and risk owner
03	Value	The intended result and baseline are measurable	Unit outcome, current performance, target and attribution method
04	Economics	Total cost and demand behaviour are understood	Licences, inference, tools, data, storage, support and people cost
05	Architecture	The design is efficient and portable	Model routing, caching, context, retrieval, integration and exit design
06	Authority	Agent actions and permissions are bounded	Identity, least privilege, approvals, limits, logging and kill switch
07	Assurance	Quality, security and compliance are evidenced	Evaluation, privacy, security, monitoring, incident and change controls
08	Lifecycle	Scale, renewal and retirement are governed	Review date, usage evidence, benefit evidence and decommission plan

Decision Rule

A failed hard gate moves the initiative to Prepare or Monitor. A strong narrative, senior sponsor or attractive market cannot replace missing authority, evidence, delivery capacity or operating control.

SECTION 01

Readiness Framework

Translate ambition into a shared executive view of value, evidence, capability and risk.



MANAGEMENT ASSESSMENT MODEL

Readiness Dimensions

No.	Decision area	Management evidence	Status
01	Portfolio visibility	Agents, copilots, APIs, embedded features, pilots, contracts and consumption	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**
02	Business value	Outcome baseline, adoption, task completion, quality and financial attribution	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**
03	Cost economics	Total cost of AI, allocation, unit cost, forecast, anomaly and avoidable spend	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**
04	Technical efficiency	Model fit, context, caching, retrieval, tool use, loops, latency and portability	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**
05	Risk and authority	Data, identity, permissions, human approval, security, privacy and incident control	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**
06	Operating governance	Policy, intake, production gates, renewal, showback, review and retirement	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**

Evidence Standard

Assessments should distinguish verified evidence from management confidence. Where evidence is incomplete, record the gap, owner, completion date and decision that depends on it.

STRATEGIC READINESS DEPENDENCIES

What Readiness Depends On

Dependency	Why it matters	Evidence management should expect
Inventory	Every agent and AI service is visible	Enterprise register, discovery evidence, contract and technical identifiers
Ownership	Business and technical accountability is named	Outcome owner, product owner, cost centre and risk owner
Value	The intended result and baseline are measurable	Unit outcome, current performance, target and attribution method
Economics	Total cost and demand behaviour are understood	Licences, inference, tools, data, storage, support and people cost
Architecture	The design is efficient and portable	Model routing, caching, context, retrieval, integration and exit design
Authority	Agent actions and permissions are bounded	Identity, least privilege, approvals, limits, logging and kill switch
Assurance	Quality, security and compliance are evidenced	Evaluation, privacy, security, monitoring, incident and change controls
Lifecycle	Scale, renewal and retirement are governed	Review date, usage evidence, benefit evidence and decommission plan

ROALLA Interpretation

Dependencies should be evaluated as a connected system. A weakness in ownership, data, architecture, delivery or governance can change the economics and risk of an otherwise attractive initiative.

SECTION 02

Detailed Readiness Assessment

Convert executive intent into verifiable requirements, accountable evidence and clear remediation actions.



READINESS CHECKLIST

AI Portfolio and Cost Readiness

Completion standard Mark Ready only when the supporting evidence has been verified. Assign an evidence owner to every open item.

Gate	Readiness requirement	Ready	Gap	Evidence owner
A01	The organization has one current register of AI agents, copilots, model services, embedded AI features and pilots.	☐	☐	_____
A02	Discovery includes expense claims, browser and identity data, cloud invoices, API keys, SaaS contracts and vendor add-ons.	☐	☐	_____
A03	Every registered item has a business owner, technical owner, risk owner, cost centre, purpose, status and review date.	☐	☐	_____
A04	Overlapping agents and AI services are mapped by workflow, user group, capability, data source and vendor.	☐	☐	_____
A05	Total cost includes licences, tokens, compute, tools, retrieval, vector storage, egress, observability, support and labour.	☐	☐	_____
A06	Usage and cost can be allocated to an agent, product, workflow, team, environment and outcome.	☐	☐	_____
A07	Each production use case has a pre-AI baseline and a unit measure such as cost per resolved case or completed task.	☐	☐	_____
A08	Budgets, quotas, anomaly alerts and rate limits exist at enterprise, product and environment levels.	☐	☐	_____
A09	Unused seats, dormant agents, abandoned pilots and idle commitments are reviewed before renewal.	☐	☐	_____
A10	Finance and technology reconcile forecast, actual cost, realized value and remediation action at least monthly.	☐	☐	_____

READINESS CHECKLIST CONTINUED

AI Policy and Engineering Controls

Completion standard Use Gap to create a dated remediation action and identify the management decision that cannot proceed.

Gate	Readiness requirement	Ready	Gap	Evidence owner
B01	Policy defines approved, restricted and prohibited uses by data class, decision impact and external exposure.	☐	☐	_____
B02	Every agent uses a unique managed identity, least privilege, approved tools and time-bounded credentials.	☐	☐	_____
B03	Human approval is required before material financial, customer, employment, legal or security actions.	☐	☐	_____
B04	Model routing uses a lower-cost qualified model by default and escalates only when measured quality requires it.	☐	☐	_____
B05	Prompt and context budgets, output limits, scoped retrieval, caching and batch processing are designed and monitored.	☐	☐	_____
B06	Agent loops have maximum steps, retry limits, timeout, spend ceiling, circuit breaker and kill-switch controls.	☐	☐	_____
B07	Logs connect prompts, models, tools, actions, users, costs, outcomes and exceptions without retaining excess personal data.	☐	☐	_____
B08	Evaluation covers task success, error, hallucination, bias, security, privacy, latency, cost and human rework.	☐	☐	_____
B09	Vendor and model changes trigger reassessment of data use, pricing, quality, portability, security and contractual exposure.	☐	☐	_____
B10	Renewal requires measured use, value and control evidence; retirement removes access, keys, data, integrations and spend.	☐	☐	_____

WEIGHTED EXECUTIVE ASSESSMENT

Readiness Scorecard

Dimension	Weight	Evidence standard	Score	Status
Portfolio visibility	20%	Agents, copilots, APIs, embedded features, pilots, contracts and consumption	__/20	Strong / Developing / Gap
Business value	20%	Outcome baseline, adoption, task completion, quality and financial attribution	__/20	Strong / Developing / Gap
Cost economics	15%	Total cost of AI, allocation, unit cost, forecast, anomaly and avoidable spend	__/15	Strong / Developing / Gap
Technical efficiency	15%	Model fit, context, caching, retrieval, tool use, loops, latency and portability	__/15	Strong / Developing / Gap
Risk and authority	15%	Data, identity, permissions, human approval, security, privacy and incident control	__/15	Strong / Developing / Gap
Operating governance	15%	Policy, intake, production gates, renewal, showback, review and retirement	__/15	Strong / Developing / Gap
TOTAL	100%	Weighted executive assessment	__/100	Pursue / Prepare / Monitor

Decision Thresholds

Score	Posture	Management decision
75 to 100	**PURSUE**	Proceed to bounded execution subject to no hard-gate failure.
50 to 74	**PREPARE**	Complete a focused readiness plan before major commitment.
0 to 49	**MONITOR**	Resolve foundational gaps before investing further.

A single material hard-gate failure overrides the weighted score. ROALLA also applies judgment where administrative readiness is high but strategic value, adoption or commercial viability is weak.

SECTION 03

Execution and Advisory Roadmap

Create control through visibility and evidence first, then optimize architecture and commercial commitments without suppressing useful experimentation.



Recommended 90 Day Mobilization

Timing	Focus	Key activities	Management output
Days 1 to 15	Discover	Build the register from finance, procurement, identity, SaaS, cloud, API, architecture and business evidence.	Verified AI portfolio
Days 16 to 35	Baseline	Attribute total cost, usage, ownership, outcome, risk, overlap and renewal exposure by service and agent.	Cost and value fact base
Days 36 to 55	Decide	Classify keep, optimize, consolidate, renegotiate, replace, pause or retire and confirm production gates.	Decision portfolio
Days 56 to 75	Control	Approve policy, identity, authority, data, evaluation, telemetry, budget, incident and exception controls.	AI control standard
Days 76 to 90	Optimize	Implement model routing, prompt and context budgets, caching, limits, showback and priority commercial actions.	Measured savings roadmap

Twelve to Twenty Four Month Path

- Quarter 1: create the enterprise register, cost taxonomy, ownership model, production gate and initial policy.
- Quarter 2: consolidate overlap, remove dormant spend, establish routing and caching, and instrument priority agents.
- Quarters 3 and 4: negotiate commitments using measured demand, scale unit economics and automate policy enforcement.
- Year 2: operate AI as a governed product portfolio with continuous evaluation, chargeback or showback and scheduled retirement.

ROALLA ADVISORY MODEL

How ROALLA Can Help

ROALLA coordinates the commercial, technology, operating and risk decisions needed to make AI economically accountable. The objective is not to centralize every experiment or reduce spend indiscriminately. It is to preserve useful innovation while eliminating duplication, uncontrolled consumption, weak architecture and agents that cannot demonstrate an outcome.

ROALLA workstream	Executive value
Portfolio discovery	Find and classify contracted, embedded, expensed, cloud-based and internally built AI services and agents.
AI economics	Define the total-cost taxonomy, allocation model, avoidable-spend rate and outcome-based unit economics.
Use case and product review	Challenge overlap, business value, adoption, baseline, product ownership and scale decisions.
Architecture optimization	Design model routing, caching, context, retrieval, orchestration, observability and portability patterns.
Policy and controls	Create acceptable-use, data, identity, authority, evaluation, incident, cost and lifecycle requirements.
Vendor and licensing	Rationalize licences, compare commercial models, improve commitments and protect exit options.
Operating model	Establish intake, production gates, FinOps cadence, decision rights, showback and exception governance.
Ongoing assurance	Monitor cost, value, risk, vendor change and emerging agent requirements for executive decisions.

Recommended Initial Mandate

- Four-week AI agent, service and cost governance diagnostic.
- Enterprise register and total-cost baseline with duplicate, dormant, unallocated and uncontrolled spend findings.
- Avoidable AI Spend Rate calculated from company data with keep, optimize, consolidate, renegotiate and retire actions.
- Executive AI policy, production gate, 90-day action plan and quarterly portfolio review pack.

CONTROL FRAMEWORK

Key Risks and Controls

Risk	Exposure	ROALLA control
False benchmark	A generic percentage creates an unsupported savings promise.	Use company evidence; treat published cloud and survey figures as context, not entitlement.
Shadow portfolio	Embedded, expensed and team-procured AI remains invisible.	Use multi-source discovery and require registration before production or renewal.
Runaway agents	Loops, retries and tools consume spend or take unintended action.	Set maximum steps, quotas, approvals, timeouts, circuit breakers and kill switches.
Premium default	High-cost models process routine work without quality justification.	Benchmark task performance and use tiered routing with controlled escalation.
Hidden total cost	Token price obscures data, tooling, people and rework cost.	Use a total-cost taxonomy and agent-level unit economics.
Weak authority	Agents receive shared credentials or excessive system access.	Use managed identities, least privilege, tool allowlists and logged approvals.
Value theatre	Adoption or activity is mistaken for business impact.	Measure task success, quality, human rework and outcome delta against baseline.
Lock-in	Data, prompts, workflows and commitments become difficult to move.	Design portability, export, contract, abstraction and exit controls before scale.

Professional Advice

Qualified legal, privacy, security, tax, accounting, employment and regulatory advisors should validate matters within their professional scope. ROALLA coordinates those inputs with technology strategy, architecture, commercialization, governance and transformation decisions.

OFFICIAL EVIDENCE BASE

Selected Official Sources

These sources support the management principles summarized in this guide. Standards, laws, guidance and organizational obligations continue to evolve and must be confirmed for the specific context before acting.

FinOps Foundation State of FinOps 2026. Official source — AI cost management is the leading capability gap as FinOps expands across AI, SaaS, licensing, cloud and data centre spend.

FinOps Foundation FinOps for AI. Official source — AI economics require allocation, forecasting, optimization and value measurement because cost cycles and consumption are unusually dynamic.

FinOps Foundation AI spend budget busters. Official source — Total cost extends beyond tokens and compute to orchestration, vector databases, observability, evaluation, storage and supporting services.

Flexera State of the Cloud 2026. Official source — Cloud waste increased to 29 percent in the reported sample as cloud-based AI workloads expanded. This is a cloud benchmark, not a universal AI overpayment rate.

Capgemini Research Institute On Demand Tech Paradox. Official source — A 2025 survey of large organizations found 68 percent reported overspending on generative AI. The figure describes incidence, not the percentage overspent.

NIST AI Risk Management Framework Generative AI Profile. Official source — Lifecycle risk management, governance, measurement, monitoring and documentation guidance for generative AI.

Government of Canada Guide on the Use of Generative AI. Official source — Canadian guidance on evaluating need, managing risk, protecting information, maintaining accountability and measuring performance.

Office of the Privacy Commissioner of Canada Generative AI Principles. Official source — Privacy commissioners call for necessity, proportionality, accountability, transparency, safeguards and impact assessment.

OWASP Top 10 for Agentic Applications 2026. Official source — Current agentic risk guidance covering goal hijack, tool misuse, identity and privilege abuse, supply chain risk and unexpected execution.

AWS Well Architected Agentic AI Lens Cost Optimization. Official source — Practical techniques include tiered model selection, caching, scoped retrieval, allocation tags and inference auditing.

Microsoft Foundry Model Router. Official source — Difficulty-aware routing can reserve frontier models for tasks that justify their added capability and cost.

Advisory Disclaimer

This ROALLA guide is a strategic readiness and marketing document. It is not a certification, audit opinion, legal opinion, privacy opinion, security assurance, investment recommendation or guarantee of results. Management must validate current obligations, company facts and professional advice before making material decisions.